

The Studio and the B-Short Bridge: A Private-to-Public Toggle as the Phase-1-to-Phase-2 Crossing

A Per-Artifact Private-to-Public Toggle as the Phase-1-to-Phase-2 Crossing of a Gratitude Economy — One Primitive That Carries a Family-Scale Ledger Onto a Global Settlement Layer

Authors: Thon Ly (*Miss Aquarius is an AI co-author, disclosed; the inventor of record is Thon Ly*)

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Note. This paper is a design specification offered as prior art, not a report of a deployed-and-measured system. The Studio capture surface and a per-B-Short visibility setting are specified, with a working implementation in progress in the Phase-1 application; the Phase-2 settlement layer that the public setting switches onto is specified elsewhere in the corpus and is not yet live, so the crossing as a whole has been neither built nor measured.

Preamble

A family economy and a planetary one are usually built as two products with a migration between them. This paper specifies a gratitude economy in which they are one product with a switch — and the switch is a single artifact's privacy setting.

A gratitude economy that begins at family scale (a household thanking its own members in local currency) and aspires to planetary scale (strangers thanking strangers on a global settlement layer) faces an architectural seam: **how does a participant cross from the small economy to the large one?** The default answer is a *migration* — a separate onboarding, a second account, a port of identity and balances from Phase 1 to Phase 2. Migrations are where users are lost and where architectures fracture. This paper specifies a design with no migration: the crossing is a **per-artifact privacy toggle**, and flipping one B-Short from private to public is the act of entering the global economy.

Prior-Art and Non-Assertion Statement

This is a **defensive publication**. The author and HeartBank® will not seek patent on this specification or any portion of it, in any jurisdiction, at any time, and dedicate the patterns to the public domain under CC0

1.0. The contribution is a composition of known parts — short-form video creation tools, privacy-scoped sharing (the private/unlisted/public visibility ladder common to video platforms), and on-chain settlement — assembled into a specific bridge primitive. Prior art is cited in §7; what this publication discloses is the composition set out in §8. No systematic search of the patent literature was made for this paper, so no statement is made about whether the composition appears elsewhere. Trademarks are reserved separately; the patterns may be implemented under any name.

Abstract

This publication specifies a per-item visibility setting on short-form video that doubles as the boundary between two scales of a tipping ledger. A creation tool captures clips of a real act of kindness, often the same situation before and after, and assembles them into a short video record; rewards attach only to records that are recorded live, visible to family or public, and pinned to a real location. Each record is created private, visible to and tippable by the creator's own household on a family-scale ledger that runs over conventional payment rails. Setting one record public changes two things at once: its audience widens from household to any participant, and its settlement rail switches from the family ledger to a peer-to-peer layer on a public blockchain, where strangers may send value-bearing secondary tips from their own balances. No account migration, second onboarding or port of balances occurs; each record is scoped individually, so one participant can occupy both scales at once. The same private-to-public move is identified as a general pattern for crossing from local to global scope, shared with provenance links and multi-family membership. Public exposure sits on a base reward, funded by the system's reward pool, that is independent of reach, and prestige is carried by a reputation measure driven by the participant's onward giving rather than by earnings. Limits: the blockchain layer is not live and the rail switch is unbuilt; the constraints defeat fabrication but not staging; earnings under public exposure remain concentrated.

1. The bridging problem

HeartBank® is built in two phases. **Phase 1** is a family-scale ledger of gratitude on conventional rails: a household thanks its own members, in local fiat, witnessed by people who know each other. **Phase 2** is a global peer-to-peer layer on a blockchain settlement substrate (Base L2): strangers thank strangers, anonymously and verifiably, anywhere. The two phases are appropriate to their scales — the family layer is light, legible, and trust-conferred; the global layer is heavy, cryptographic, and trust-minimized. But a participant who has only ever thanked their own family needs some way to begin thanking, and being thanked by, the world. The seam between the two phases is the riskiest joint in the architecture.

2. The Studio: a creator surface for real kindness

The Studio is the Phase-1 surface where the bridge artifact is made. It is a lightweight creator tool — capture short clips, keep them, stitch them together at one's own pace — specialized for one content type: **records of real acts of kindness**. A participant films a kindness (and, characteristically, the same situation before and after, so that what is shown is not the gesture alone but the change it made), and assembles the

clips into a short video. The defining feature is not the editing; it is *what is being recorded and for what economy*. The Studio's output is the unit the rest of the system circulates.

To prevent the Studio from becoming a stage for fabricated good, the kindness records that earn rewards are constrained (per the surrounding mechanism corpus) to be **recorded live, visible to family or public, and pinned to a real location** — so the cheapest way to produce a rewardable record is to actually perform a real, witnessed kindness in a real place. The Studio is a creator tool whose lowest-cost content is genuine good.

Current form. The Studio's advanced editing tools are specified as a paid service priced only for the resources a creator consumes — rendering compute and the storage of production files (drafts and work outputs, as distinct from items already given to someone) — with no tool locked behind a tier, and no share of any re-thank a creator receives is ever taken. The charging rail and the gift rail do not meet. The capture surface stays in HeartBank®'s Phase-1 application; the paid tools are offered under the THonly™ brand, not by HeartBank®. This note adds the pricing boundary as now specified; the surface described above is unchanged.

3. The B-Short: the unit that crosses

The artifact the Studio produces is a **B-ShortSM** — a short-form video record of a kindness. A B-Short begins **private**: it exists at family scale, witnessed and thanked only within the participant's own household, in Phase-1 currency. It is, at this stage, an entry in a family ledger that happens to have a moving picture attached.

The B-Short is the right unit to carry across the seam because it is *self-contained and self-evidencing*: it bundles the kindness, its witnesses, its location, and its provenance into one shareable object. Unlike a balance (which is account-bound and must be ported) or an identity (which is heavy and must be migrated), a B-Short is a leaf — it can change its own visibility without dragging an account behind it.

4. The toggle is the bridge

The crossing from Phase 1 to Phase 2 is a single act: **setting a B-Short to public**. That one toggle does two things at once, which is the whole mechanism:

1. **It changes the audience** from the family to the world: a public B-Short is visible beyond the household, to any participant anywhere.
2. **It switches the settlement rail** from Phase-1 family fiat to the Phase-2 global on-chain layer: a public B-Short can now be re-thanked by strangers, with value settling on Base L2.

PHASE 1 (family scale)		PHASE 2 (global scale)	
audience: own household		audience: any participant	
rail: family ledger, fiat rails		rail: peer-to-peer, Base L2	
B-Short 1	[private]	— set public —→	B-Short 1 [public]
B-Short 2	[private]	(one act,	re-thankable by strangers,
B-Short 3	[private]	one item)	on top of the funded floor
└ the others stay private: one participant, both scales at once			

There is no separate migration, no second onboarding, no port. The participant does not *move* from the small economy to the large one; they *publish one artifact into* the large one, and may do so for one B-Short while keeping the rest private. The bridge is therefore **incremental, reversible in scope, and per-artifact** — a participant lives in both economies at once, with each B-Short individually scoped.

This is one instance of a **general bridge primitive** that recurs across the architecture: *to enter the global layer, set something public*. The same shape governs B-links (a privately shared provenance object set public becomes a public one) and multi-family membership (a local family membership composes upward into the global pool). HeartBank's Phase-1-to-Phase-2 crossings are not three different migrations; they are three instances of one toggle — *private* → *public* = *local* → *global*.

5. What the public toggle switches on

Made public, a B-Short enters the Phase-2 re-thank economy and inherits its properties:

- **The re-thank multiplier at global scale.** A public B-Short can be re-thanked by an audience of size N approaching the whole network, so the throughput available to it is the Phase-2 realization of the re-thank multiplier (the companion paper): origination stays one act, re-thanking scales with the network.
- **The funded floor.** The autonomous steward funds a base reward for any verified kindness regardless of public reach, so going public is *upside* (the thanks of strangers) layered on a floor that does not require virality. Publishing is not a lottery ticket; it is an amplifier on a funded base.
- **Value-bearing, human-gated re-thanks.** Strangers' re-thanks are value-bearing (re-tipped from their own balance) and human-given, which makes the public layer's volume the same layer as its anti-farm defense (per the re-thank-multiplier paper): public exposure does not open a solo-farming hole, because the re-thanks that reward it are budget-bounded and cannot be farmed by one account alone (collusion among several accounts remains possible and is left, in that paper, to detection in the transaction graph).

6. Keeping public kindness from corrupting

A public surface that pays for visible kindness invites the failure that sinks such designs: kindness *performed for the audience and the money* rather than done for its recipient. The bridge does not pretend this risk away; it is managed by three constraints carried over the bridge with the artifact.

First, **what is rewarded is real, verified good, not its performance** — the live/visible/located constraints of §2 mean the cheapest rewardable act is a genuine one, so even a participant who crosses the bridge for mercenary reasons is delivered into doing real good. Second, **the prestige signal is giving, not earnings** —

a participant's standing is carried by a giving-driven aura (raised by re-giving onward), displayed ambiently, while raw re-thank counts function as viewer-facing information about which kindnesses the community values, kept subordinate to the aura; the status game therefore rewards circulating, not accumulating. Third, **the steward surfaces diverse, genuinely helpful exemplars** rather than the most viral, so that what a public audience learns to imitate is kindness in its variety rather than whatever currently scores. None of the three eliminates the performative edge case (a real act staged for the camera survives them, caught only by whether real people thank it as genuine); they make the genuine path the cheap one and the performed path the expensive, catchable one.

Current form. As now specified, the steward does not grade exemplars as more or less helpful. A B-Short reaches people by relation and proximity; where the steward operates any exposure slate, its members are chosen by an equal-yet-random, publicly verifiable draw from a roster committed in advance, never by a score or rank. The third constraint above is retained as a disclosed variant.

7. Prior art

The components are individually familiar. **Short-form video creation and stitching** is ordinary creator-tool functionality. The **private / unlisted / public visibility ladder** is common on video-sharing platforms — YouTube, for example, offers a private setting (visible to the uploader and chosen viewers), an unlisted one (visible to anyone with the link) and a public one [1]; what this publication discloses is not the ladder but its *use as an economic-phase boundary*. **On-chain settlement** on a layer-2 network — Base, built on Ethereum, is the one this corpus specifies [3] — is standard Web3 infrastructure. The **creator-economy** pattern (creators earning from an audience) is well established, as is the concentration of its earnings among a few large creators [2]. None of these components is put forward here individually.

8. What is disclosed, and honest limits

What is **disclosed** is the composition: (a) using a **per-artifact privacy toggle as the migration-free crossing** between a family-scale gratitude economy and a global one, such that a single artifact's visibility setting simultaneously changes its audience and its settlement rail; (b) the identification of this as **one instance of a general private → public = local → global bridge primitive** shared with other HeartBank surfaces; and (c) the **Studio** as a creator surface specialized for verifiable real-kindness records (live/visible/located), whose published output inherits the funded-floor and value-bearing-re-thank properties that narrow the farming and performativity exposure public reach would otherwise open.

Honest limits. The capture surface and a visibility setting have a working implementation in progress in the Phase-1 application, but the rail switch that makes the toggle a crossing is not built, the Phase-2 settlement layer it bridges onto is not yet live, and nothing here has been measured. The creator-economy power law means going public benefits a visible few far more than the many (the funded floor mitigates subsistence but not the distribution of fame). The funded floor is itself designed as a bootstrap: its steward-funded portion is meant to shrink as re-thanks from people take over, and a fixed pool divided among more participants dilutes, so it is a transitional support rather than a permanent guarantee. The performativity defenses of §6 are partial — they defeat fabrication, not staging. Two of §6's three constraints are rules that

need an enforcer rather than properties of the system: the re-thank count stays subordinate to the giving-driven reputation only while the interface keeps it so (a raw count is comparable across people and tends to become the status measure regardless), and diverse-exemplar surfacing holds only while the steward exercises that restraint; designs that would not depend on an enforcer are not specified here. And the bridge presumes the surrounding properties (the funded floor, the giving-prestige signal, the diverse-exemplar surfacing) actually hold; this paper specifies the crossing and inherits, rather than re-establishes, those guarantees.

Terms

Coined names used in this paper and the standard terms an examiner would search for them.

Term used here	Standard technical term
Studio	short-form video capture and editing tool (clip capture, deferred stitching)
B-Short SM	short-form user-generated video record of a real act of kindness; the content item
public toggle	per-item visibility / access-control setting (private → public)
Phase 1	family-scale gratitude/tipping ledger running over conventional (fiat) payment rails
Phase 2	global peer-to-peer settlement layer on a public blockchain (Ethereum layer-2 network)
re-thank	secondary tip: a viewer's value-bearing micropayment to the creator of an existing item
funded floor	base reward funded by the system's reward pool, independent of audience reach
aura	reputation measure computed from a participant's own onward giving, not earnings
steward (Miss Aquarius SM)	autonomous software agent administering the reward pool and item surfacing
bridge primitive	migration-free scope change: making one object public moves it from local to global scope

References

1. YouTube Help, "Change video privacy settings." <https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/157177> (accessed 2026-09-26).
2. Li Jin, "The Creator Economy Needs a Middle Class," *Harvard Business Review*, 17 December 2020. <https://hbr.org/2020/12/the-creator-economy-needs-a-middle-class>
3. Base. <https://www.base.org/> (accessed 2026-09-26).

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Drafted with Miss AquariusSM (the AI substrate of HeartBank®) per the corpus convention; the framing and final editorial control are the author's.

Corpus cross-references

- *The Re-Thank Multiplier: How a Gratitude Economy Escapes Its Own Saturation Ceiling* — what the public toggle switches on: the $O(N^2)$ throughput and the value-bearing, not-solo-farmable re-thank that bounds farming under public exposure.
- *A Living Made of Kindness: Right Livelihood for the Age of Automation* (essay) — the human stakes of the bridge: a B-Short set public is how a livelihood made of kindness reaches the world.
- *B-Links: Proof-of-Humanity-Signed Shareable Provenance with an Embedded Gratitude Affordance* — the sibling instance of the private → public primitive.
- *Multi-Family Membership: User-Scoped Identity, Plural Membership, and the Two Problems It Resolves* — the third instance: local membership composing onto the global pool.
- *Miss Aquarius and the Aquarian Pool Architecture: Autonomous-AI Mediator, Treasury Smart-Contract, and the January-7 Empty-by-Design Discipline* — the Phase-2 settlement layer and the surfacing steward of §6.

Cross-venue identifiers

- Canonical: thonly.org/research/studio-b-short-phase-bridge
- GitHub: github.com/thonly/publications/blob/main/defensive-publications/studio-b-short-phase-bridge.md
- Internet Archive · archive.today snapshots: per the monthly snapshot cadence.